The National Archives reference FO 17/676

709

No 219

Peking
Novr. 16. 1874.

My Lord,

Upon the 6th Instant the Prince of Kung addressed a Circular Despatch to the Legations inclosing copy of the agreement and guarantee signed on the 31st of October by the Grand Secretary Wênsiang and his colleagues on behalf of China, and by the High Commissioner Okubo and the Minister Yanagiwara on the part of Japan. I inclose translation which I have authorised Mr. Medhurst to publish at Shanghai.

The,

Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

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I saw the Prince at the Yamên on the 4th Instant when I went to present Mr. Fraser. His Highness was very full of acknowledgements

I have the Honor to be with the highest Respect My Lord, Your Lordship's Most obedient, humble Servant

Thomas Francis Wade.

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Peking, November 6th 1874.

Copy.

The Prince of Kung to H.B.
M. Minister.

In the matter of Formosa,
the British Minister was earlier
put in possession of the
correspondence relating to the
expedition sent by the
Government of Japan against
the tribes [on that island]. An
understanding having now
been arrived at with the
Government of Japan, by which
the troops are to be withdrawn
(1) and the case (1) closed, all the
Correspondence is to be Considered
non.

(1) The case of Japan against the Savages.

1874
Peking. Nov. 6
Pce of Kung
No 219
Rec'd Jan 26
by Mail
Formosa.
Agreement
Commenced
by Pce of Kung.
28.
by Paris for Paris

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non avenue and the discussion
dropped for evermore. The tribes
on Formosa whether reclaimed
or unreclaimed being alike
within the dominions of China,
it is of course the duty of the
Chinese Government to bring
them under control as to
decrease the navigation [along
their coasts] against any
repetition of their atrocities;
that so friendly relations may
be made to endure. It is now
the duty of the Prince to
Communicate to the British
Minister Copy of the articles
[of Agreement signed,] and of
the

the engagement [that they shall
be fulfilled.]

A necessary Communication.

Tsung Chih 13th yr. 9th moon. 28th day.

Inclosures

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Inclosures Annexed.

Instrument recording the several propositions considered by the two contracting parties and the action which both agree shall be taken thereon.

Whereas the subjects of every government are entitled to its protection against injury, an obligation rests upon every government to adopt measures by which their safety shall be provided for, and should any trouble have come upon [the subjects of] any particular government, it is incumbent upon that government to institute inquiry

inquiry and take action.

Certain Japanese subjects having been wantonly murdered by the unreclaimed savages on Formosa, the Government of Japan regarding these savages as responsible despatched a force against them to exact satisfaction. An understanding has now been come to with the Government of China that this force shall be withdrawn and certain farther steps taken, all which is set forth in the three articles following:

Article I. The present proceedings having been undertaken by

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by the Government of Japan for the humane object of affording security to its own subjects, the Government of China will not therefor impute blame to it.

Article 2. The Government of China will give a certain sum to compensate the families of the shipwrecked Japanese who were murdered [on Formosa]. The roads made and buildings erected by the Japanese on the ground, the Government of China is prepared to retain for its own use, and it agrees to make a farther payment on this account. The details of the

the engagement on these points will be elsewhere stated.

Article 3. All correspondence that this question has occasioned between the two Governments shall be cancelled and the discussion dropped for evermore. It will be the duty of the Chinese Government to take such steps for the due control of the savage tribes in the regions referred to as will for ever secure the navigation [along their coasts] against any farther atrocities on their part.

Guarantee

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Guarantee or Engagement referred to in the foregoing Instrument.

Translation.

Paper attesting an Engagement entered into.

In the matter of the savages of Formosa, reference being had to an understanding arrived at with the two Governments [of China and Japan] by the British Minister Mr. Loade, and to the Instrument this day signed recording the action to be taken respectively by the two parties thereto, the Chinese

Chinese Government will at once give the sum of 100,000 Taels to compensate the families of the shipwrecked Japanese who were killed. In addition to this, the Chinese Government will not fail to pay a farther sum of 400,000 Taels on account of the expense occasioned by the construction of roads and erection of buildings which when the Japanese troops are withdrawn, the Chinese Government will retain for its own use. It is farther agreed that on (or, by) the 20th day of the 12th month of the 7th year

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year of the Reign Hsieng Chih (Japanese Style) and on the 12th day of the 11th moon of the 13th year of the Reign Tung Chih (Chinese Style),* the Government of Japan shall withdraw the whole of its troops, and the Government of China shall pay the whole of the money, neither party being behind the time now fixed. The payment of the sum guaranteed will not be completed by the Chinese Government, so long as any part of the troops of the

* 20th December, 1874

the Government of Japan be not withdrawn.

This instrument is drawn up in guarantee of the agreement. [It is in two parts whereof] each party to it retains one.

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Peking
November 16. 1874

N° 220

My Lord,

In continuation of the foregoing Despatch I have the Honor to inclose copies of two Despatches I had addreped to Sir Charles Shadwell regarding the Agreement signed by the High Commipioner of Japan, and the evacuation of Formosa.

The first is to claim his influence, which I felt sure would be valuably exerted, towards the prevention of remarks that might be distasteful to the Government either of China or Japan, in respect of the terms of the Agreement.

The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

Copy
Sir T. Wade
Pekin
6 Nov: 1874.

Encl: 2 in
Sir T. Wade's dis. 219
of 16 Nov: 1874.

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